Research Ethics Approval Form

Section One: Basic details

Project title	Zero trust models and how limiting access can strengthen cybersecurity
Student name	Pham The Dang
Student number	BH01842
Programme	Research report
School	Btec Ha Noi
Intended research start date	Januara 9, 2026
Intended research end date	April 18, 2026

Section Two: Project summary

Please select all research methods that you plan to use as part of your project:

- ✓ Interviews
- ✓ Questionnaires
- • Observations
- • Use of personal records
- ✓ Data analysis
- • Action research
- • Focus groups
- • Other (please specify

Section Three: Participants

Please answer the following questions, giving full details where necessary.

Will your research involve human participants?

- ✓ Yes

Who are the participants? Tick all that apply:

- ☐ Children aged 12–16
- ☐ Young people aged 17–18
- ✓ Adults

How will participants be recruited (identified and approached)?

Participants for this study will be recruited using aConvenience Sampling strategy, which is well suited to efficiently collecting data from a specific, accessible demographic. The primary target group for this study includes: university students and IT professionals, selected because of their high level of engagement with media and digital technology, making their views on deepfakes particularly relevant.

Describe the processes you will use to inform participants about what you are doing:

To ensure all participants are fully informed and can provide meaningful consent, a clear and comprehensive introductory statement will be presented before any data is collected. The process will be slightly tailored for each recruitment method (online questionnaire and expert interviews) to ensure clarity and appropriateness.

How will you obtain consent from participants? Will this be written

The process for obtaining consent is designed to be explicit, informed, and respectful of participant autonomy. It will be implemented differently for the two distinct participant groups (online survey respondents and expert interviewees) to suit the context of the interaction. Consent will be obtained through a mandatory, explicit action at the beginning of the online questionnaire (hosted on Google Forms) and a two-stage consent process will be used, combining written information with verbal confirmation.

? How will it be made clear to participants that they may withdraw consent to participate at any time?

It will be made explicitly clear to all participants, both in writing and verbally where appropriate, that their consent is ongoing and can be withdrawn at any time.

Studies involving questionnaires:

Will participants be given the option of omitting questions they do not wish to answer?

- ✓ Yes
- ☐ No

If No please explain why below and ensure that you cover any ethical issues arising from this:

Studies involving observation:

Confirm whether participants will be asked for their informed consent to be observed.

- ✓ Yes
- ☐ No

Will you debrief participants at the end of their participation (i.e. give them a brief explanation of the study)?

- ✓ Yes
- ☐ No

Will participants be given information about the findings of your study? (This could be a brief summary of your findings in general.)

- ✓ Yes
- ☐ No

Section Four: Data storage and security

Confirm that all personal data will be stored and processed in compliance with the Data Protection Act (1998):

- ✓ Yes
- ☐ No

Who will have access to the data and personal information?

Only the researcher and academic supervisor (Dinh Van Dong) will have access.

During the research:

Where will the data be stored?

Data will be stored in a secure, password-protected Google Drive folder. Interview recordings will be stored locally in an encrypted format.

Will mobile devices (such as USB storage and laptops) be used?

- ✓ Yes
- ☐ No

If yes, please provide further details:

Yes, mobile devices will be an integral part of the research process for data collection, analysis, and storage. The use of these devices will be governed by strict security protocols to ensure the confidentiality and integrity of all research data.

After the research:

Where will the data be stored?

Upon completion of the research project, all data will be securely stored at the following locations to ensure long-term integrity and security at the Institutional Server, Secondary Storage

How long will the data and records be kept for and in what format?

Data will be stored for 6 months post-submission in digital format. All iden:fiable data will be deleted after that period.

Will data be kept for use by other researchers?

- ✓ Yes
- ☐ No

Section Five: Ethical issues

Are there any particular features of your proposed work which may raise ethical concerns? If so, please outline how you will deal with these:

Yes, the proposed research on implementing a Zero Trust–based internal monitoring system involves ethical considerations because it handles sensitive user data and monitors employee activities. Key concerns include privacy, data protection, transparency, and potential misuse of monitoring authority.

To address these issues, the system limits data collection to security-related activities only, ensures secure storage and encryption, applies strict Role-Based Access Control (RBAC), logs administrative actions for accountability, and guarantees informed consent for research participants.

It is important that you demonstrate your awareness of potential risks that may arise as a result of your research. Please consider/address all issues that may apply. Ethical concerns may include, but are not limited to the following:

• **Informed Consent:** All participants in surveys or interviews will be fully informed about the research purpose and their right to withdraw at any time.
• **Sensitive Topics:** Since internal monitoring may raise privacy concerns, the study ensures that only security-related activities are monitored, not personal data**.**
• **Risk and Dual-Use Concerns:** Technical details of the system (e.g., authentication and access control mechanisms) will not be publicly disclosed in ways that could expose vulnerabilities or be misused.
• **Confidentiality and Anonymity:** Participants' identities and any organizational data will be anonymized and protected.
• **Data Storage and Security:** All collected data will be securely stored, encrypted where necessary, and accessible only to authorized individuals.
• **Reporting and Dissemination:** Findings will be reported honestly and responsibly, focusing on best practices without revealing sensitive security configurations.

Section Six: Declaration

I have read, understood and will abide by *[insert centre name]* Research Ethics Policy:

- ✓ Yes
- ☐ No

I have discussed the ethical issues relating to my research with my Unit Tutor:

- ✓ Yes
- ☐ No

I confirm that to the best of my knowledge:

The above information is correct and that this is a full description of the ethics issues that may arise in the course of my research.